

MANDAR DEODHAR

MEGHNAD DESAI | b. 1940 |

Economist and author

An economist by training and a contrarian by instinct, Desai's academic work ranged from Marx to markets, but his public life, especially in Britain's House of Lords, revealed a sharper pleasure in puncturing moral complacency. He relished being misunderstood, often defending unpopular positions simply because they were insufficiently examined. In an era of tidy answers, Meghnad Desai thrived on productive discomfort.



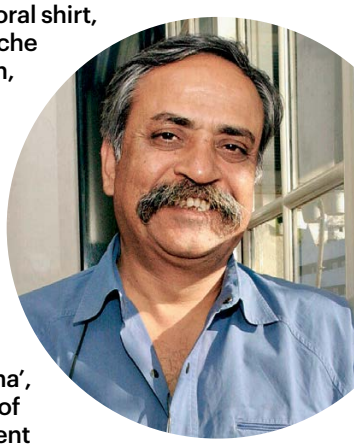
MAYADHAR RAUT | b. 1930 |

Odissi dancer

Among those who emerged from training in its precursor form, Gotipua, and went on to shape the contours of modern Odissi, Mayadhar Raut's name ranks high. Immersed in both theatre and dance since childhood, he was one of the first few Odissi practitioners to study at Kalakshetra in what was then Madras. Back in Cuttack, he infused new ideas into Odissi. But it was in New Delhi that Raut would strengthen his legacy, moulding a new generation of artistes at the Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra.

PIYUSH PANDEY | b. 1955 |

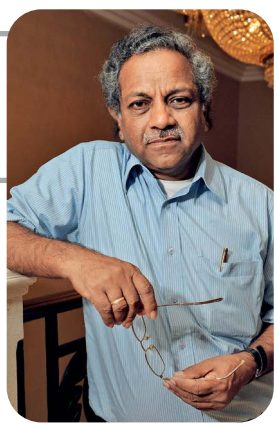
Advertising professional



As a state-level cricket player for Rajasthan, Piyush Pandey loved playing on the front foot. He adopted the same principle in advertising too. An industry colossus who sported a floral shirt, a big, bushy moustache and a booming laugh, he loved looking the part as an A-lister in Indian advertising. From Cadbury's joyous cricket field jaunt to Asian Paints' 'Har Ghar Kuch Kehta Hai' commercials, from 'Fevicol ka majboot jod' to 'Chal meri Luna', Pandey was at helm of campaigns which went viral before social media. Pandey was the brains behind two seismic slogans: 'Do Boond Zindagi Ki' and 'Ab ki baar Modi sarkaar'. One helped eradicate polio in India, the other boosted the electoral appeal of Narendra Modi in 2014.

SHAJI N. KARUN | b. 1952 |

Filmmaker



GETTY IMAGES

A gold medallist in cinematography from FTII, Pune, Shaji was a favourite of Malayalam auteurs such as Aravindan, K.G. George and Padmarajan in the 1970s and '80s. His debut film as director, *Piravi* (The Birth), which turned an infamous police atrocity case from the Emergency period in Kerala into a piece of tragic poetry, won a Camera d'Or Special Mention at the 1988 Cannes festival. Shaji's other movies include *Vanaprastham* and *Swaham*. The director was also a mainstay in bringing international cinema to Kerala audiences, starting with the International Film Festival of Kerala, which he handheld in its first few years (1998-'01).